



THE CHUKCHI PEOPLE LIVE ON THE FURTHEST northeastern part of CHUKCHI

LIVING ON THE EASTERN TIP OF SIBERIA

The administrative language of the area is Russian but the Chukchi language still exists. Only about five percent of

Divided people

The Chukchi are divided into two groups: the coastal Chukchi, who have permanent homes on the coast, and the inland Chukchi, who breed reindeer and migrate with them between summer and winter pastures in the Boreal forest. There has always been a friendly alliance between the two, which comes in handy when trading items, such as fish and reindeer skin.



HOME OR AWAY

Most Chukchi live in small towns scattered along the coast and inland, such as this town of Uelen, which is famous for carvings. Some of the inland Chukchi, however, are seminomadic, moving with herds of reindeer biannually from the tundra to the taiga and back.

THE PEOPLE ON THE COAST

The coastal Chukchi live in settlements along the coast on the very northeastern part of Siberia. They survive by fishing and hunting marine animals, such as seal and walrus. They still use traditional walrus skin boats, called *umiak*, that are made of wooden frames. In the winter it is sometimes necessary to drag the *umiak* miles over the ice to the water.

These boats can vary from 9-30 ft (3-9 m) long and be up to 8 ft (2.5 m) wide.

The Chukchi use hessian-filled bags as saddles when riding reindeer.



CHUKCHI SEASONS

The Chukchi divide the year into five seasons according to natural phenomena such as the rising and setting of the sun, numbers of mosquitoes, and the state of the snow. *Leleng* is their winter, which they then subdivide into three. So it could be said that the Chukchi have seven seasons.